Silicon Valley Woman of Influence 2017 as selected by the Silicon Valley Business Journal

Maria Sendra

Member of the California State Bar

Disruptive Technology Thought Leader

Managing Director of Global Partnering for Mid-to-Large Emerging Enterprises

With a distinguished career in global corporate finance law that spans over 20 years, Maria Sendra is a globally recognized thought leader for emerging and disruptive technologies. Serving on the Silicon Valley Comes to Oxford Technology thought leader panels for 14 consecutive years, Maria shared insights and best practices for scaling innovation alongside the founders of Google, Tesla Motors/Space X, and Facebook.

Maria solidified her place at the forefront of blockchain, artificial intelligence, and machine learning development over the course of her career as a Partner at globally leading firms such as Clifford Chance—a magic circle firm out of London—Baker & McKenzie, Jones Day, Dentons, and Greenberg Traurig. Using expertise in diligence, transactional structuring, and strategic leadership, she forged compliance best practices and frameworks needed for blockchain interfaces in high-growth sectors.

In 2018, while still a Partner/Shareholder at Greenberg Traurig, Ms. Sendra's role shifted from Outside General Counsel to Strategic Executive and Board Advisor when she founded Silicon Valley Global Scaling, a transformational technology consultancy. As the company's CEO, she supports former and current founders, c-suites, and federal governmental transactional leaders of multi-sector projects ranging from multibillion-dollar Stem Cell Regeneration Medicine to Mobile Communications and Real Estate. In 2021, she also launched Sunshine Innovation Fund, where she serves as the CEO and CIO.

Leveraging significant board advisory and corporate governance experience, Maria helps clients leverage capital markets, private equity, and technology relationships in key jurisdictions worldwide. Since 2014, she served as a Director for the Institute of Americas, a board consisting of c-level executives from Latin America focused on bridging innovation business opportunities between the Americas. She also currently serves as a member and Strategic Advisor to the Southern California Regional Airport Exploratory Board.

Past board and executive committee memberships include seats on the board of CommNexus. This San Diego non-profit association focuses on growing local technology businesses by providing access to capital, talent partners, and business development opportunities. She also served on the board of Weal Life, a San Francisco-based digital healthcare company.

Fluent in English, Spanish, French, and Valenciano and proficient in German, Ms. Sendra has a background in Molecular Biophysics and Biochemistry from her studies at Yale University, where she ran a research lab. She has also worked as a filmmaker at Harvard University. She also holds a Master of Arts with distinction from Indiana University and a Juris Doctorate from the University of California Berkeley School of Law, earning the Award for Excellence in Written Advocacy.

Besides being an integral part of building game-changing businesses, Maria is also incredibly proud of her fantastic family. Maria raised two children to be global citizens and entrepreneurs. Today, her son Alex owns a technology and innovation consulting company in Taipei and is currently helping Google map Southeast Asia. Her daughter Vanessa, a Rhodes Scholar Nominee, is currently obtaining an M.S. in Innovation Management and Entrepreneurship from the Graduate School of Engineering at Brown University.

Passionate about travel herself, Maria has traveled with her family across the US, Europe, and Asia. Athletic and energetic, her spare time is spent learning aerial yoga and keeping up with disruptive technology developments through fintech, AI, digital currency, blockchain, and autonomous vehicle analyst reports. Her particular interests are in Tesla, Zoom, Zillow Square, Roku, Pinterest, and Facebook.

Presentations & Publications

- **Technology Thought Leadership:**

Silicon Valley Comes to Oxford Panelist, 2002–2016 *alongside the founders of LinkedIn • Twitter • Facebook • PayPal • Google • Evernote • Yelp • Tesla Motors/Space X*

US Biotech, Pharmaceuticals, & Innovation Sectors, Brazilian Congress on Science & Technology, 2015

Infocast & CommNexus Panelist, Chair, & Executive Committee

"Communications Technologies in the Cleantech Space: Current & Future Opportunities"

"Turning a New Leaf—The Future of Electric Vehicles & Networked Charging Stations"

"Financing New Technology Outlook"

"Equity Perspectives on Investments in Wind Power Market"

"Using DOE Loan Guarantees in Renewable Energy Finance"

"Growth Capital: Private Equity Perspective"

"The Public Capital Markets: What are the Opportunities for Solar Companies"

- **Blockchain**

Blockchain, Crypto, & SEC Compliance, Blockchain Economic Forum, 2019

"Smart Contracts Lead the Way to Blockchain Implementation" (Q2 2019), Thomson Reuters, Beckham and Sendra

Blockchain Expo NA, Santa Clara, 2017

- **Digital Cities**

"Digital Cities' Challenges for Data Privacy [& Analytics]," Stanford Global Projects Center, 2017

"Commercial Opportunities & [Smart City] Business Models," Stanford University Digital Cities Summit, 2016

- **Business Management & Scale**

"Business & Management Best Practices in the Next Era," ACC Lead Presenter, 2017

"Scaling Your Business Globally: The Big Picture Questions in the Current Financial Markets" (July 2012) Global Business Magazine

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